

I start by searching meta-search engines that scour other websites for great deals.

Metasearch sites pore through direct sites, OTA (Booking, Expedia, Makemytrip etc.), wholesalers, tour operators and give you aggregated results. Examples are Skyscanner, Kayak, Hipmunk, Google.

Step 1: Start with Kayak and click on the ‘explore’ option. Have the city you live-in as the home airport. Choose ‘any month’ option and this gives you an overall panned view of which place is cheaper to travel from your home. After making a generic search record down the average prices to various destinations. With this method, hidden gems are easily located. For example: if Mumbai is your hub - Cape Town, Madagascar and sometimes Morocco offer two-way flights for under 20k. If Delhi is your hub - St. Petersburg, Moscow (Pegasus Airlines), Perth, Tokyo (Air Asia), Kyrgyzstan and Kenya offer sub 20k two-way flights. These aren’t special offer prices that stay on for a week and then go back up. These routes are traditionally cheaper because of several reasons such as

- High volume of travellers
- Hub of an airline
- Administrative convenience of the airline
- Revenue meetings convene and top executives decide on these prices (maybe refueling in Moscow could be beneficial!)

After you finish your search in Kayak and found some hidden gems, keep abreast of the places. Move over to Step 2 for more choices.

Step 2: Proceed to Skyscanner. Do the same search with your home airport. Choose the ‘flexible - anywhere’ option as the destination and the ‘cheapest month’ for travel dates. This will give you a comprehensive list of places you can travel from your home. If you don’t like the options available now, keep searching. Log back tomorrow and do the same. Within a few weeks, you’ll find either a mistake fare or a discounted fare to a destination you’ve never been to.